



Voice search

A new Yahoo! app for iPhones allows users to search and surf using a voice interface



Freneq

Mozilla has launched an alpha version of a Windows Mobile browser, Freneq

13.4 Million

The number of people in the United States who watched videos on their mobile phones in Q1. Up from 8.8 million last year.

Q I have AMD Athlon X2 4400+ CPU, Gigabyte GA-M61SME-S2 motherboard. My PCs PSU is CIL-Odyssey 450W. I want to add a ATI Radeon 4850 or 4830 or NVIDIA GeForce GTS 250 graphics card. Can I do this? Is there is any performance drop of a graphic card because of a PSU? Will these cards be bottlenecked with my CPU and board. I want to play *F.E.A.R. 2* and *Crysis* at maximum resolutions (1600 x 1200). Another problem with my processor is that it heats up to 90 or 100 degrees centigrade when I play games like *NFS Prostreet* and *Carbon*.

Savender Moondi

A Firstly, your CPU will get fried if you do nothing. Probably the contact between the CPU and its heatsink isn't proper or the fan could have died. Please get this checked ASAP. Also your motherboard is a value option and while its not going to bottleneck your performance your CPU most definitely will. I suggest an upgrade to a Core 2 Duo at least. You could pick up a good P45 motherboard for around Rs. 8,000. A Core 2 Duo E8400 will set you back by another Rs. 8,000 bucks. Next, upgrade to 4 GB of DDR2 RAM. This will cost you around Rs. 3,500. Then buy a GTS 250 graphics card for Rs 10,000. If you can spend up to Rs 14,000 the GeForce GTX 260 will really do the trick.

Q I have the following - CPU: Core 2 quad q9550, motherboard: ASUS P5QE, RAM: 2 x 2 GB Corsair 800 MHz DDR2, HDD: WD 1 TB, PSU: Corsair TX 650, cabinet: CM 690, monitor: Acer AL1916. I'm extremely confused between a HD 4870x2 and an NVIDIA GTX 295 and my budget is Rs 35,000.

Gopal Chatterjee

A I recommend the NVIDIA GTX 295. It's within your budget. Look for brands like ZOTAC, EVGA, ASUS, Gigabyte or XFX. And please upgrade that monitor to at least a 22-inch and possibly a 24-inch for the best experience.

Q I want to buy an LCD monitor in the range of 22 inches or above for gaming. Please

suggest one. My budget is Rs. 25,000.

Archit Arora

A I recommend Dell's UltraSharp 2209WA, its an IPS panel and will give you great colours and contrast, expect to pay around Rs 20,000 for this one. In the 24-inch category there are only TN panels, although if you do want something look for options from BenQ, LG and Samsung. These will be well within your budget.

Q I have the following configuration: Processor : Intel Core 2 Quad 8200; Motherboard : Asus DG-31; RAM : 2 x 2 GB DDR2 Corsair XMS; Hard Disk : Seagate 500GB; Graphics card : Palit 9600GT 1GB Sonic; SMPS : Zebronic 500W; Cabinet : Zebronic.

Currently I have an LG 700E (CRT monitor) with a maximum resolution of 1280 x 1204. I am basically building it for gaming and running software like Maya, 3D Max, etc. What will be a better option - Intel Core 2 Duo 7400 or Intel Core 2 Quad 8200? My budget is Rs. 30,000.

Mikoo Dutta

A I recommend sticking with the quad core if you are working on 3D animation packages. I also recommend upgrading to a better monitor in the long run. Go for a 22-inch LCD. The Palit 9600 GT is a good choice and stick with 4 GB of RAM. The rest of the configuration is fine.

Q I want to buy a laptop. It'll be used for programming, music and gaming. I've been looking at the Dell Studio 15 (after configuring it as needed). Will it be able to run games like *Crysis*? What are my other options? My budget is Rs.55,000.

Viky Singhal

A First of all forget playing *Crysis* at decent resolutions on a notebook in that price - its not going to happen. Dell's Studio 15

is a good option for that price although you may want to spend around Rs 15,000 more and get the Studio XPS 16 with a better configuration.

Q My current handset is Motorola C168, which is three years old. I want to buy a new smartphone (budget around Rs. 8K-9K)

My requirements are:

1. I'm not a music lover, so Walkman or XPressMusic is not required. Normal mp3 player is enough.

2. I like to click pictures, so preferably 3.2 MegaPixel Camera, but even 2.0 MegaPixel Camera would be fine.

3. Important - Wireless Connectivity through GPRS, 3G etc, as I'm planning to use it for wireless internet.

4. Most Important - I know Java quite well, and I'm planning to learn J2ME in these summer holidays. So, I want to develop J2ME applications for my mobile.

Trivikram Kamat

A I recommend Sony Ericsson's K810. It's got a good camera, the processor is snappy and it is a 3G handset. In short, its got all the goodies you want. And the sound quality is pretty good even though you don't especially need it.

Q I am a frequent reader of Digit for the past 2 years. I have read all the issues till date. I need to buy a Graphic Card. I have the following configuration: ASUS P5GC-MX FSB1333 motherboard, RAM - Transcend 1GB Ram x 2 (DDR2 667), CPU - Intel Core 2 Duo E4500 @2.20 GHZ. I use Windows Vista SP2 32bit. Do I need a graphics card to play games like *NFS ProStreet*? My budget is Rs 2,500

Samyak Jain

A I'd say buy a GeForce 8400 GS with 128 MB of RAM and you will be able to just about play *ProStreet*. If you want to really have fun you may want to

look at a GeForce 9600 GT. This card will cost you around Rs 6,000 but its totally worth it.

Q I want to purchase headphones within Rs. 1,000. I was thinking bout buying the Sennheiser MX360 which has a price tag of Rs. 690 and is well within my budget. I also liked the iBall DJ900 which costs Rs.900. I would want an all round performer for listening mainly to rock bands. The iBall is also a sound isolating set. Which pair would deliver more bass? Which would deliver clearer highs?

Aditya Mukherjee

A I have not tested either of these headphones so I cannot comment. But in lieu of the Sennheiser MX 360 that are simply earbuds I can recommend the Creative EP 630 and EP 830. Both of these are excellent at noise isolation and I find them quite comfortable. The EP630 is priced at around Rs 850 while the EP830 is priced at Rs 1,200. The difference between the two is mostly cosmetic although the EP 830 seem to have a slightly more rigid connecting cable.

Q I want to buy a decent video player PMP with nice music playback. I am unable to decide which one. Should I go for Cowons D2+ for more storage space, as I can expand the memory. Or should I go for a larger screen but less storage space? If I should go for a bigger screen for good movie player should I go for S9 or Apple's i-Touch? All of them are in my budget.

Rachna Vidyarthi

A Your choice all depends on whether you want it primarily for music or video. The Cowon D2+ is a good option for both music and video but it has a small screen. Its music quality is terrific. Apple's iPod Touch is also superb at both music and video with a larger, crisp screen but the problem of proprietary video formats persists. I would recommend Cowon's A3 if you want a great video PMP. If you want a music based PMP I'd recommend the 8 GB Cowon D2+. You can add a 32 GB SD card later. **A**